

was very angry. He immediately started to gather the largest army Greece had ever seen. He was joined by many heroes, including his brother Agamemnon, king of Mycenae, the crafty Odysseus of Ithaca, and the most fearsome warrior of them all, Achilles.

*Achilles was half-mortal, half-god, which made him practically unbeatable in battle.*

In the meantime, Paris had taken Helen home to Troy. Paris's family was far from happy. "Please return Helen to Sparta," begged Hector, his heroic elder brother.

"If you don't, you will start a war between us and the Greeks," said Priam, Paris's father. Paris stubbornly refused.

Menelaus was now ready to set off from Greece to claim Helen back. Between them, the soldiers filled more than a thousand ships. The army sailed across the perilous Aegean Sea directly to Troy. However, the city was surrounded by towering stone walls that were impossible to break down, and the Trojans had barred all the gates. The Greeks would have to lay siege to Troy and stop supplies from reaching the city to make the Trojans surrender. The Trojan War had begun.

*Menelaus launched a fleet of more than a thousand ships to bring Helen back.*

